



Android Malware Hunting Cheat Sheet

Field-ready reference • Modern Android (10+) • Non-root & Root paths

QUICK TRIAGE **START HERE**

```
$ adb shell pm list packages -f | sort
```

```
$ adb shell cmd package list packages --show-versioncode
```

```
$ adb shell appops query-op --user 0 RUN_IN_BACKGROUND
```

```
$ adb shell dumpsys package > /sdcard/pkg.txt
```

```
$ adb shell settings list secure | grep -i debug
```

```
$ adb shell logcat -v time -d | grep -iE \"dex2oat|zygote|frida|magisk\"
```

```
$ adb shell ps -A | grep -iE \"frida|magisk|xposed\"
```

```
$ adb shell ls -la /data/local/tmp/
```

```
$ adb shell dumpsys activity processes | grep -i suspicious
```

```
$ adb shell ip addr ; adb shell ip route
```

SUSPICIOUS APP LOCATIONS

/data/app/[package]-*/ – Installed APKs/odex

/data/data/[package]/ – App sandbox (db/prefs/files)

/data/user/0/[package]/ – Primary user app data

/storage/emulated/0/Android/data/[package]/ – Ext. app data

/system/priv-app/ – System-priv APKs (rogue?)

PERSISTENCE & AUTOSTART

/data/system/packages.xml – Installs/permissions

/data/system/package-usage.list – Last-used apps

/data/system/package-restrictions.xml – Enabled/disabled states

/system/etc/init.d/ – Legacy boot scripts

/data/adb/modules/ – Magisk modules

```
$ adb shell cmd package query-permission android.permission.RECEIVE_BOOT_COMPLETED
```

ROOT • HOOKING • TAMPERING

/system/xbin/su , **/system/bin/su** – Root binaries

/data/adb/magisk/ – Magisk artifacts

/data/local/tmp/frida-server – Frida hook

/data/data/de.robv.android.xposed.installer/ – Xposed

/system/framework/ – Injected jars?

```
$ adb shell ls -la /system/xbin /system/bin | grep -i su
```

C2 • CONFIG • PAYLOADS

/data/data/[pkg]/shared_prefs/ – XML configs, endpoints

/data/data/[pkg]/files/ – Dropped payloads

/data/data/[pkg]/databases/ – Tokens/URLs

/data/local/tmp/ – Staging area

/system/etc/hosts – DNS hijack

```
$ adb shell grep -RinE \"http(s)?://|wss://|mqtt\" /data/data/[pkg]/
```

NETWORK & EXFIL

/proc/net/tcp , **/proc/net/udp** – Sockets

/proc/net/unix – Local sockets (IPC)

/data/system/netstats/ – Per-app usage

/data/misc/net/ – Net cfg/state

/data/misc/wifi/WifiConfigStore*.xml – Known SSIDs

```
$ adb shell logcat -d | grep -iE \"ssl|tls|cert|socket|http\"
```

USAGE • TELEMETRY • APPOPS

/data/system/usagestats/ – FG/BG app events
/data/system/appops.xml – Permission ops
/data/system/uiderrors.txt – UID error traces
/data/system/notification_policy.xml – Notification policy

```
$ adb shell appops get [package]  
RUN_IN_BACKGROUND
```

LOGS • CRASH • BOOT

/data/system/dropbox/ – System events
/data/anr/traces.txt – ANR traces
/data/tombstones/ – Native crashes
/sys/fs/pstore/ – Persistent crash
/data/misc/bootstat/ – Boot/reset stats

```
$ adb shell logcat -b events -d | grep -i crash
```

CREDENTIAL & ACCOUNT SURFACES

/data/system/locksettings.db – Lock creds (hashed)
/data/system_ce/0/accounts_ce.db – Accounts/tokens
/data/misc/keystore/ – Keystore blobs
/data/system/sync/accounts.xml – Sync config

```
$ adb shell dumpsys account
```

HIDDEN • TEMP • MEDIA ABUSE

/data/local/tmp/ – Temp payloads
/storage/emulated/0/Download/.*/ – Hidden dirs
/storage/emulated/0/.nomedia – Scanner evasion
/storage/emulated/0/Android/data/[pkg]/cache/ – Droppings

```
$ adb shell find /storage/emulated/0 -type d -  
name \"\".*\" -maxdepth 3
```

BROWSER • WEB ARTIFACTS

/data/data/com.android.chrome/
app_chrome/Default/History – History
/data/data/com.android.chrome/
app_chrome/Default/Cookies – Cookies
/data/data/org.mozilla.firefox/files/
mozilla/ – Profiles
/data/data/com.android.browser/
databases/browser2.db – Legacy

```
$ adb shell strings /data/data/  
com.android.chrome/app_chrome/Default/  
Preferences | grep -i url
```

RUNTIME • PROCESS FORENSICS

/proc/[pid]/maps – Mappings
/proc/[pid]/fd/ – Open files
/proc/[pid]/cmdline – Launch args
/proc/[pid]/environ – Env vars

```
$ adb shell for p in $(pidof -s [package]); do  
cat /proc/$p/cmdline; done
```

SIGNALING • TELEPHONY

/data/user_de/0/
com.android.providers.telephony/
databases/mmssms.db – SMS/MMS
/data/user_de/0/
com.android.providers.telephony/
databases/telephony.db – SIM / carriers
/data/user_de/0/
com.android.providers.contacts/
databases/calllog.db – Calls

```
$ adb shell content query --uri content://sms  
--limit 5
```

TRIAGE QUERIES (NON-ROOT)

List pkgs \$ adb shell pm list packages
-f
App info \$ adb shell dumpsys package
com.target.app
Running \$ adb shell dumpsys activity
processes
Net \$ adb shell ip addr ; adb
shell ip route
Logs \$ adb logcat -d | tail -n 200

TRIAGE QUERIES (ROOTED)

UID map # grep -R \"u0_a\" /data/
system/packages.list
Find ELF # find /data -type f -perm
-111 -exec file {} \\; | grep
ELF
Open net # cat /proc/net/tcp /proc/
net/udp
Recent # ls -lt /data/local/tmp |
head
Strings # strings /data/data/[pkg]/
lib/* 2>/dev/null | grep -i
\"http\\|key\\|token\"